

The OS That Tells the Truth About Education

India's first smart career guidance platform — we treat a college degree like a financial investment and tell you exactly whether it's worth it, before you spend a single rupee.

₹33Cr

Revenue target, Year 3

57.4%

Profit margin by Year 3

96×

Value earned per ₹1 spent acquiring a user

Month 19

When we stop losing money (break-even)

THE SHORT VERSION

Everything You Need to Know — One Page

WHY WE EXIST

India Lens is the first platform that **treats a college degree like a financial investment** — calculating whether it will actually make you money, whether the loan will ruin you, and whether AI will take your job, all before you pay anything. Every other platform earns money by selling your contact details to colleges. We earn money only when we genuinely help you.

TOTAL MARKET SIZE ₹180B The total size of India's college guidance, student loan, and online course markets. 4.3 crore students enroll in college every year.	WHEN WE BECOME PROFITABLE Month 19 We stop losing money by month 19. After that, we are fully self-sustaining and do not need any more investment to survive.	YEAR 3 REVENUE ₹33.70Cr Earned from 4 different income streams — so no single stream failing can sink the company. Profit margin of 57.4% by year 3.	FUNDING WE ARE RAISING ₹8.5 Cr Covers 18 months of operations. Used to build the product, sign bank partnerships, and grow the student network.
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WHAT WE ARE DOING DIFFERENTLY	WHAT EVERY OTHER PLATFORM DOES	WHAT INDIA LENS DOES INSTEAD
How We Make Money	Sell student phone numbers to colleges — highest bidder wins	We earn only when students make better decisions — our incentives match yours
AI Job Risk	Zero platforms tell you if your chosen career will be automated away	We show exactly which parts of your job AI will replace — and what skills to learn to stay safe
Loan Safety Check	Push students to borrow as much as possible; no risk warning	We run 10,000 "what-if" computer simulations to tell you the exact chance you'll default on your loan
Salary Data	Show unverified numbers from college marketing brochures	Use AI models trained on real salary data to predict your earnings 20 years into the future
Personal Fit	Generic college rankings — same list for everyone	An adaptive quiz figures out your personality and risk tolerance; every recommendation is tailored to you
Proof of Your Work	A self-typed Word-doc resume anyone can fake	Digitally signed research papers, mentor recommendation letters, and verified code — employers trust it like a background check
Bank Partnership	No platform offers banks a way to check student credit risk	Banks pay us ₹85 per check to use our student loan risk tool before approving a loan



Rankings judge colleges. India Lens judges whether a college is right for you.
The only platform that earns money by helping you — not by selling your data to the college that bids the most.

HOW BIG IS THE OPPORTUNITY

₹180B Market. We Go After Where the Money Is Most Concentrated.

Four large markets sit right next to each other — college guidance, student loans, online courses, and career data tools. None of them are being served honestly. We are the first platform addressing all four.

₹180B

TOTAL MARKET (ALL OF INDIA)

Every business in India that helps students pick a college, take a loan, learn a skill, or find a job. 4.3 crore students enroll every year. This market is growing at 19.4% per year.

₹38B

MARKET WE CAN REALISTICALLY REACH

Students in cities and towns with internet access who are actively deciding on college or a career upgrade. About 1.1 crore students per year — the ones we can genuinely serve right now.

₹2.8B

OUR YEAR 3 REALISTIC TARGET

A conservative 7.4% slice of the reachable market — students making big degree decisions, plus 12 bank partnerships and 40 coaching institute software deals.

FOUR REASONS THE TIMING IS PERFECT RIGHT NOW

AI FEAR IS REAL

68%

Of Indian students say they are scared AI will take their job — yet no platform tells them which careers are safe or what skills will protect them.

BANKS ARE LOSING MONEY ON STUDENT LOANS

₹39,000Cr

Bad student loans on bank books (RBI data 2025). Banks desperately need a tool to check if a student can actually afford to repay before giving the loan. We built exactly that.

FAKE RESUMES ARE A CRISIS

84%

Of Indian companies say they cannot trust what candidates write on their own resume. Our verified portfolios — where a third party confirms everything — solve this directly.

AI IS NOW AFFORDABLE

↓78%

The AI tools we use (Perplexity + DeepSeek) cost 78% less than older AI platforms. For the first time, we can give every student a personal AI advisor for less than ₹10 per session.

INCOME STREAM	TOTAL POOL	HOW WE EARN FROM IT	YEAR 3 TARGET
College Guidance and Matching	₹62B	We charge ₹4,500 for each pre-verified student we send to a college or bank — not ₹300 for a cold phone number	₹890 L
Student Loan Origination	₹78B	Banks pay us 1.5% of the loan value when a student we vetted takes a loan through them	₹580 L
Online Course Sales	₹28B	We earn 25% commission — but only show a course when our system is confident it matches what that specific student needs	₹420 L
Research Portfolio + Group Programs	₹8B	₹35,000 for a 6-week guided research program that produces real, published work students can show employers	₹1,680 L
Total India Lens Revenue Target — FY 2028			₹3,370 L (₹33.70 Cr)

WHY THIS MARKET IS BROKEN

The People Supposed to Help Students Are Actually Working Against Them

₹300 What portals charge colleges per student contact sold	1.2% How many of those cold leads actually enroll	65% Students in programs that don't match their financial situation	₹2.1L Commission study-abroad agents earn per student they place abroad	0 Platforms that warn students about AI replacing their career
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✗ WHAT HAPPENS RIGHT NOW

- **College portals earn ₹300** for every student contact they sell — they sell it to whoever pays the most, not the best college for that student. You get spam calls from colleges you've never heard of.
- **Study-abroad agents earn ₹2L–₹4L per student placed** — paid by the foreign college, not by you. They push you toward whatever college pays them the most, even if the loan will cripple you financially.
- **Salary numbers come from college brochures** — not real data. Nobody tells you which jobs AI will automate in 5 years. Nobody checks if your loan is actually payable on your expected salary.
- **Students borrow lakhs** for degrees that have a very high chance of leaving them unable to repay. Not one platform warns them before they sign.

✓ WHAT INDIA LENS DOES INSTEAD

- **We calculate the financial return on every degree** — like a profit-and-loss statement for your education. You see exactly what you'll earn, when you'll break even on the degree cost, and whether it's actually worth it.
- **We run 10,000 "what-if" loan scenarios** — simulating salary dips, interest rate changes, and recession hits — and tell you the exact probability you'll struggle to repay, before the bank approves the loan.
- **Our AI Disruption Tracker** checks every career weekly against live job listings — showing which skills AI is replacing right now and which ones make you safe from automation for the next decade.
- **We build students a verified digital portfolio** — published research papers, mentor recommendation letters, and real code contributions. Employers trust it like an official background check, not a self-written resume.



Rankings judge colleges. India Lens judges whether a college is right for you.

The only platform whose business only works when students genuinely benefit — not when colleges pay the most for your phone number.

OUR PROPRIETARY ENGINE

Math Models + Live Web Intelligence + AI — Built to Give Honest Answers

LIVE WEB SEARCH TOOL

Perplexity Sonar Pro

Looks up current college fees, placement records, and job market conditions in real time — from verified online sources, not old databases. Like having a research assistant that reads the internet for you instantly.

Cost: ₹0.40 per search · ~10 searches per student session = ₹4

PERSONAL AI ADVISOR

DeepSeek V3

Remembers everything about you across sessions — your goals, budget, risk appetite, and past questions. Gives honest advice even when it's hard to hear. Never just tells you what you want to hear.

Cost: ₹5.50 per full session · Remembers up to 128,000 words of context

TOTAL AI COST PER STUDENT

~₹9.50 Per Full Session

Both tools combined. 78% cheaper than the previous generation of AI tools. This is what makes it possible to offer a personal AI advisor to every student affordably, while still making strong profit margins.

↓78% cheaper than prior generation · Profit margin on AI features: 95%+

STEP 01

We Collect Real Data

- Government wage surveys by state
- Real salary history from working professionals
- Live job postings (analysed weekly)
- Bank interest rate forecasts
- Official college placement reports

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STEP 02

Our Math Models Process It

- Personality quiz (8 smart questions)
- AI salary prediction model (20-year forecast)
- Career path simulator
- 10,000-scenario loan stress test
- Job automation risk calculator

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STEP 03

AI Explains It in Plain Language

- Perplexity checks the latest online data
- DeepSeek explains results specific to you
- Remembers all your past conversations
- Always honest — never flatters you
- Every claim backed by a source

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STEP 04

What You Get

- Is this degree worth the money?
- Can you safely afford this loan?
- Will AI replace your career?
- A verified portfolio employers trust
- Courses you actually need right now

MODEL 1 · IS THE DEGREE WORTH IT?

Bar chart icon

Degree Return Calculator (NPV Engine)

$$NPV(s,p) = \sum [\dot{S}(t) \cdot (1-Tax) \cdot P_visa(t) \cdot FX(t) \cdot (1-P_rec) \cdot (1-\delta_AI(t))] / (1+r(t))^t - Tuition \cdot (1+Infl)^d - OC_PLFS \cdot d$$

Works like a financial model for your degree — adds up all the money you'll earn over 20 years, then subtracts tuition, living costs, and lost income while studying. Also adjusts for job risk, currency risk, and AI disruption. Gives you a single number: is this degree worth more than it costs?

20-Year Return

Break-Even Point

Rate of Return

MODEL 2 · WILL AI TAKE YOUR JOB?

House icon

AI Job Risk Tracker

$$\delta_AI(p,t) = D_0(p) \cdot (1-H(p)) \cdot (1-e^{-(\lambda t)}) \cdot M(p,t)$$
$$M(p,t) = 1/(1+e^{-(k(t-t_0(p))}))$$
Calibrated weekly from live job posting data

Reads thousands of live job postings every week to track which skills are disappearing from listings (being replaced by AI) and which are growing. Shows you a risk score for your chosen career — and the exact skills that will keep you safe over the next 10 years.

Risk Score

Safe Skills List

Timeline

MODEL 3 · WHO ARE YOU REALLY?

Personality icon

Smart 8-Question Personality Quiz

$$P(x=1|\theta,a,b,c) = c+(1-c)/(1+e^{-(a(\theta-b))})$$
Stop: $SE(\hat{\theta}) < 0.35$ or $n \geq 8$ questions
Traits: $\{\theta_risk, \theta_value, \theta_autonomy, \theta_ai\}$

An adaptive quiz that adjusts its next question based on your previous answer — like a smart interview. In just 8 questions it figures out 4 hidden traits: how much risk you can handle, how urgently you need money, whether you prefer independence, and how AI-ready you are. Every recommendation is then tuned to your specific profile.

Your Risk Profile

Personalised Advice

Career Fit Score

MODEL 4 · CAN YOU AFFORD THE LOAN?

Loan icon

10,000-Scenario Loan Safety Check

10,000 computer simulations run with:
Salary dips (randomised by industry data)
Recession hits: once every ~12 years avg.
Floating bank interest rate movements
Danger flag: loan payment > 38% of salary

Before you take an education loan, our system runs 10,000 different future scenarios — salary dropping, bank rates rising, recession hitting — and tells you in plain language: what is the chance you will struggle to repay this? Banks now pay us to run this check before they approve student loans, because it saves them from bad debt.

Default Chance %

Best/Worst/Middle Case

Safe Loan Amount

India Lens · Confidential

Series A · September 2026

COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

Three Reasons Competitors Cannot Build What We Have Built

FEATURE	SHIKSHA / COLLEGEDUNIA	STUDY-ABROAD AGENTS	INDIA LENS
How They Make Money	Sell your phone number to colleges for ₹300	Earn ₹2–4L commission from the foreign college they place you in	Earn only when you make a better decision — our income depends on your outcome
Salary Predictions	✗ Copy-pasted from college brochures	✗ Outdated, unverified numbers	✓ AI model trained on real salary data — predicts your earnings over 20 years
AI Job Risk Warning	✗ Doesn't exist anywhere	✗ Doesn't exist anywhere	✓ Weekly tracker — shows which parts of your job AI will replace and when
Loan Safety Check	✗ Encourage maximum borrowing	✗ Actively push expensive foreign loans	✓ 10,000 simulations — tells you if the loan is safe before you sign
Personalisation	✗ Same rankings for everyone	✗ Manual notes from a human agent	✓ 8-question quiz + AI that remembers everything about you
Verified Portfolio	✗ Nothing	✗ Template essay edits only	✓ Published papers, signed letters, verified code — trusted by employers like a background check
Quality of Matches Sent to Colleges	1.2% of sold contacts actually enroll	Manual, expensive, slow	12.4% conversion — because students are pre-checked and willing

01

The Trap Competitors Can't Escape

Shiksha and CollegeDunia earn most of their money from low-quality private colleges. If they add our loan risk tool, that tool will tell students: "don't go to this college." Those colleges will stop paying them. **They would destroy their own income just to compete with us.** This is not a technology gap — it is a business model trap they cannot exit without going bankrupt.

02

Credentials That Cannot Be Faked

Anyone can copy a resume template. Nobody can copy our verified credential network: **research papers published on official academic platforms, recommendation letters with digital signatures, and audited code contributions employers can inspect themselves.** Recruiters treat our portfolio link like an official background check — not a student's self-description. This trust is built over years. Competitors start from zero.

03

We Get Smarter as We Grow

Portals lose the student the moment they get admitted. India Lens stays connected for 4 full years — filling skill gaps, running research programs, placing students in internships. **Every student who graduates feeds their actual salary back into our prediction models,** making our future predictions more accurate. Competitors who enter today face 4 years of our data advantage — and that gap only widens.

4 INCOME STREAMS — NONE DEPENDENT ON THE OTHERS

High Margins. Each Stream Grows the Next.
No Single Point of Failure.

STREAM 1 · DIRECT FROM STUDENTS

₹35,000

Guided Research Program

A 6-week program where a PhD mentor guides the student to produce a real, published research paper and a signed recommendation letter — things employers and universities take seriously. 40%+ of seats filled by referrals from past students.

64% profit after costs

STREAM 2 · FROM BANKS

1.50%

Loan Referral Fee

When a student we have pre-screened takes a loan from one of our partner banks (Credila, Avanse, Auxilo), the bank pays us 1.5% of the loan amount. They pay because our students are safer — they default far less than average. Earns ₹18k–₹67k per loan.

98% profit after costs

STREAM 3 · FROM COURSE PROVIDERS

25% avg

Course Recommendation Fee

We only recommend a course when our system is at least 75% confident it matches what that student needs right now. Because of this filtering, 4.2% of students buy — vs 0.8% industry average. Partners: Coursera, Udemy, Emeritus, Physics Wallah.

88% profit after costs

STREAM 4 · FROM BANKS + COACHING INSTITUTES

₹85/Check

Risk API + Coaching Software

Banks pay ₹85 each time they use our loan risk tool to check a student before approving a loan. Coaching centres (Allen, FIITJEE etc.) pay ₹400–₹800 per student per year to use our guidance platform under their own brand name.

96% profit after costs

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN 10,000 STUDENTS SIGN UP — STEP BY STEP

WHAT STUDENTS DO	NUMBER	CONVERSION RATE	WHAT WE EARN EACH	TOTAL EARNED	PROFIT %
Sign up for free (via a friend's portfolio link — zero ad spend)	10,000	100%	—	—	—
Buy a ₹1,999 verified portfolio subscription	1,350	13.5%	₹1,999	₹26.98 L	92.4%
Enroll in a ₹35,000 guided research program	250	2.5%	₹35,000	₹87.50 L	64.2%
Buy a recommended online course (avg ₹2,125 commission)	1,200	12.0%	₹2,125	₹25.50 L	88.5%
Take a student loan via our bank partners (avg ₹18,500 referral fee)	180	1.8%	₹18,500	₹33.30 L	98.0%
Total earned from 10,000 students				₹173.28 L	77.8%
Total cost to acquire 10,000 students (₹18 per student, mostly organic)				₹1.80 L	—
Value earned for every ₹1 spent on getting users (LTV / CAC)				96.2x	—

3-YEAR DETAILED FINANCIAL MODEL

Revenue, Costs, Profit, and Cash —
The Full Picture



INCOME AND COST LINE	YEAR 1 (FY26)	YEAR 2 (FY27)	YEAR 3 (FY28)	WHAT DRIVES THIS NUMBER
INCOME — 4 STREAMS				
Stream 1: Guided Research Programs + Portfolio Subscriptions	₹78.5 L	₹425 L	₹1,680 L	₹1,999 subscription + ₹35,000 program seats; 2.5% of monthly active users
Stream 2: Bank Loan Fees + Student Matching	₹38 L	₹215 L	₹890 L	1.5% of loan amount + ₹4,500 for each pre-verified student sent to a bank
Stream 3: Online Course Commissions (match ≥ 75% only)	₹24 L	₹110 L	₹420 L	25% average commission; 4.2% of students buy vs 0.8% industry average
Stream 4: Bank Risk API + Coaching Institute Software	₹12.5 L	₹85 L	₹380 L	₹85 per bank check + ₹500 per student per year for coaching software licence
TOTAL INCOME	₹153 L	₹835 L	₹3,370 L	₹1.53 Cr → ₹8.35 Cr → ₹33.70 Cr
COSTS — WHAT WE SPEND TO DELIVER THE SERVICE				
PhD Mentors + Research Reviewers	₹28 L	₹145 L	₹540 L	32% of program income; mentors who guide students through research
AI Searches — Perplexity Sonar Pro (live web lookups)	₹2.2 L	₹8.5 L	₹28 L	₹0.40 per search × 10 searches per student session; cost drops as volume grows
AI Advisor — DeepSeek V3 (personalised student reasoning)	₹2.3 L	₹9.5 L	₹34 L	₹5.50 per full session; 78% cheaper than previous generation AI tools
Credential Verification + Paper Publishing	₹4.2 L	₹14 L	₹42 L	Digital signatures, academic publishing fees, verification infrastructure
Cloud Servers + Security + Platform Hosting	₹3.3 L	₹12 L	₹36 L	AWS + Cloudflare; grows at 40% the rate of revenue growth
TOTAL COST OF SERVICE	₹40 L	₹189 L	₹680 L	Drops from 26% to 20% of revenue as we scale — costs grow slower than income
GROSS PROFIT (Income minus Service Costs)	₹113 L	₹646 L	₹2,690 L	Profit margin improves: 73.8% → 77.4% → 79.8% year on year
OPERATING EXPENSES — RUNNING THE COMPANY				
Technology + AI Research Team	₹48 L	₹130 L	₹310 L	4 people Year 1 → 9 Year 2 → 18 Year 3; avg ₹12L/year per person
Sales + Bank and Institute Partnerships	₹18 L	₹62 L	₹160 L	2 people Year 1 → 5 Year 2 → 12 Year 3; signing NBFC and coaching deals
Student Growth + Campus Network	₹22 L	₹68 L	₹180 L	Campus representatives at colleges; viral portfolio sharing; zero paid ads
Legal, Accounts, HR, and Office	₹15 L	₹37 L	₹105 L	Stays flat until Year 3 scale; includes compliance for bank API licensing
TOTAL RUNNING COSTS	₹103 L	₹297 L	₹755 L	Drops from 67% to 22% of revenue — overhead grows much slower than income
OPERATING PROFIT (EBITDA)	₹10 L	₹349 L	₹1,935 L	Profit margin: 6.5% → 41.8% → 57.4% — every rupee of revenue makes more profit each year
CASH AND RUNWAY				
Series A Investment Raised	₹850 L	—	—	Raised at the start; covers 18 months before we are self-sustaining
Cash Used While Growing (before profitability)	₹(93) L	₹349 L+	₹1,935 L+	We stop losing money by Month 19 (October 2026). Self-funding after that.

WHO WE'RE HIRING + WHAT IF THINGS GO WRONG

Hiring Plan, Revenue Chart, and Three Honest Scenarios



HIRING PLAN — WHO WE BRING ON AND WHEN

TEAM	YEAR 1 END	YEAR 2 MID	YEAR 2 END	YEAR 3 END	KEY HIRES WE ARE MAKING
Engineering + AI and Maths Research	4	6	9	18	Maths model specialist, 2 backend engineers, 1 AI infrastructure lead
Product + Design	1	2	3	5	1 senior product manager (ed-tech experience), 1 UX designer, 1 growth PM
Bank and Institute Partnerships	2	3	5	12	2 bank deal closers, 2 coaching institute deal closers, enterprise salespeople
Campus Growth Network	1	2	4	10	10 campus representatives at top colleges + 2 growth team leads by Year 3
Research + Mentor Management	1	2	4	7	PhD research fellows; IIT/IIM faculty agreements for letter-of-recommendation signing
Legal, Finance, and Operations	1	2	2	3	CFO by Year 2 mid; compliance lawyer for bank licensing
Total Team Size	10	17	27	55	Average cost ₹12L/year per person (range: ₹7L–₹22L)

YEAR 2 PROFIT — THREE HONEST SCENARIOS (WHAT IF THINGS GO WRONG?)

▼ WORST CASE

₹248 L

29.7% profit margin

Student growth 30% below plan. Banks pay a lower fee of 1.0% instead of 1.5%. We launch the bank API one quarter late. We still make a profit and have enough cash — the ₹850L investment covers this comfortably with no top-up needed.

→ OUR TARGET PLAN

₹349 L

41.8% profit margin

Students share portfolio links and the network grows organically at 18–22% per month. 3 bank partnerships signed by mid-Year 2. Past program graduates refer new students — covers 40%+ of new enrolments with no marketing spend.

▲ BEST CASE

₹540 L

55.1% profit margin

India's top 3 banks make our loan risk tool mandatory for every student loan application (pushed by the RBI's bad-loan problem). Bank API income carries near-zero cost. We could return money to investors from Year 2, Quarter 4 onwards.

SERIES A — ₹8.5 CRORE

18 Months of Runway. Four Clear Goals Before We Raise Again.

38%

Building the Technology

Strengthening our maths models. Connecting Perplexity and DeepSeek to our platform. Weekly automated data refresh pipeline. Mobile app. Bank API gateway for our loan risk tool.

₹3.23 Cr

22%

Growing the Student Network

100 student representatives at IITs, NITs, and top private colleges. Hackathon and career event series. Our main growth engine is free — students sharing their own portfolio links — this money supports that network.

₹1.87 Cr

20%

Building the Research Network

Agreements with IIT and IIM faculty to sign letters of recommendation. 3 PhD research fellows on staff. Fast-track publishing agreements with academic platforms. 6 inaugural research programs (150 students at ₹35k each).

₹1.70 Cr

12%

Signing Bank and Institute Deals

Closing 3 bank API contracts (Credila, Avanse, Auxilo). Launching 10 coaching institute software pilots. Regulatory filing to operate as a bank-facing tool. 2 enterprise salespeople dedicated to this.

₹1.02 Cr

8%

Legal, Finance, and Buffer

Data privacy law compliance. Annual audit. Regulatory approvals for the bank licensing. 12 months of office and operations costs. Cash buffer for unexpected delays.

₹0.68 Cr

4 GOALS WE COMMIT TO BEFORE RAISING AGAIN

GOAL	TARGET DATE	HOW WE MEASURE IT	WHY IT MATTERS FOR THE NEXT ROUND
● Goal 1: Stop Losing Money — become profitable	Month 19 (Oct 2026)	Monthly operating profit ≥ ₹0; no further cash injection needed	Proves the business works without needing investors to keep it alive
● Goal 2: 3 Bank Partnerships Live	Year 2 Mid (Q2 FY27)	3 active bank contracts; ₹25L+ annual income from banks alone	Proves we have a second revenue stream independent of students — de-risks the model
● Goal 3: 50,000 Verified Student Portfolios	Year 2 Q3 (Q3 FY27)	50,000 live portfolio pages with verified work; employers clicking on 25%+ of profiles	Proves the data flywheel is real — enables a talent-intelligence product for companies
● Goal 4: ₹5 Crore Annual Run Rate	Year 2 End (Q4 FY27)	Monthly income ≥ ₹41.7L for 2 months in a row; all 4 streams positive	Unlocks Series B raise at 8–10x annual run rate — target valuation ₹40–₹50 Crore